

Design Specification

Colour, typography, spacing, and component states — fixed before implementation.

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Why this exists. Every value in this document is decided once and referenced everywhere. Heading sizes, colours, spacing, and radii come from a single configuration rather than being chosen per screen — which is precisely how a build ends up with three slightly different greys and four heading sizes that were never intended to differ.

Direction

Warm neutrals	Greys with a subtle warm cast rather than pure or cool greys. Softer, and a natural pairing for the orange brand colour.
One brand colour	A single orange, used only for primary actions. Nothing else competes for attention.
Muted status	Booking and business states use desaturated colour — present and distinguishable, never loud.
Moderate radius	Neither sharp nor pill-soft. Reads as a professional tool without feeling cold.
Both modes	Light and dark are specified together. Several values are genuinely mode-specific, not inversions.

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1. Colour

Neutrals — light mode

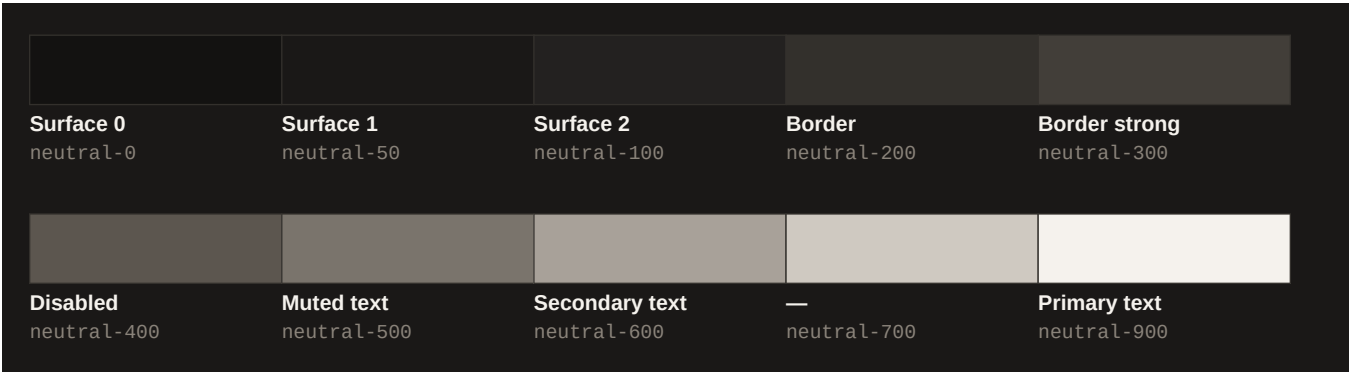
The full warm scale. Surfaces sit at the light end, text at the dark end, borders in between.

Surface 2 neutral-0	Surface 1 neutral-50	Surface 0 neutral-100	Border neutral-200	Border strong neutral-300
Disabled neutral-400	Muted text neutral-500	Secondary text neutral-600	— neutral-700	Primary text neutral-900

Token	Light value	Applies to
surface-0	#F5F3EF	Page background
surface-1	#FAF9F7	Subtle panel, table header, inset areas
surface-2	#FFFFFF	Cards, modals, raised elements
border	#E5E1DA	Default hairline between elements
border-strong	#D6D1C7	Input outlines, emphasised dividers
text-primary	#1A1815	Headings, body copy, values
text-secondary	#6B655C	Supporting copy, dates, metadata
text-muted	#8A8378	Placeholders, captions, hints
text-disabled	#B5AEA3	Disabled labels and controls

Neutrals — dark mode

Warm darks, not pure black. Same relationships, inverted — a pure-black base would discard the warmth the light palette is built on.



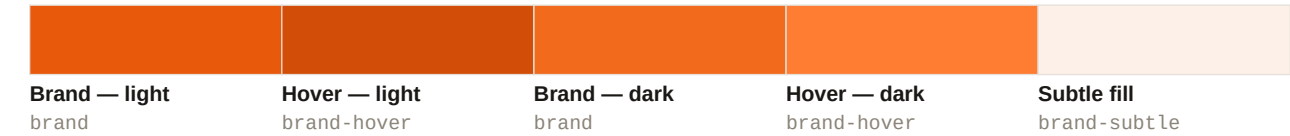
Token	Dark value	Applies to
Surface 0 neutral-0		Page background
Surface 1 neutral-50		Cards, panels
Surface 2 neutral-100		Raised elements, modals, hover fills
Border neutral-200		Default hairline
Border strong neutral-300		Input outlines, emphasised dividers
Disabled neutral-400		Disabled labels and controls
Muted text neutral-500		Placeholders, captions, hints
Secondary text neutral-600		Supporting copy, metadata
— neutral-700		
Primary text neutral-900		Headings, body copy, values

Token	Dark value	Applies to
surface-0	#131211	Page background
surface-1	#1A1817	Cards, panels
surface-2	#232120	Raised elements, modals, hover fills
border	#33302C	Default hairline
border-strong	#423E39	Input outlines, emphasised dividers
text-primary	#F5F2ED	Headings, body copy, values
text-secondary	#A8A199	Supporting copy, metadata
text-muted	#7A746C	Placeholders, captions, hints
text-disabled	#5C564F	Disabled labels and controls

Surface ordering differs by mode. In light, surfaces get *lighter* as they rise (page → card → modal). In dark, they get *lighter* too — a raised element is closer to the foreground, not further from it. The token names stay consistent; only the values flip.

Brand colour

One orange, one job: the primary action on a screen. It never appears on tabs, links, progress bars, icons, or decorative elements — that restraint is what makes it read as "this is the action".



Token	Light	Dark	Notes
brand	#E8590C	#F26B1D	Primary button fill, focus ring
brand-hover	#D14D08	#FF7C33	Hover state — darkens in light, lifts in dark
brand-on	#FFFFFF	#1A1817	Text sitting on the brand fill
brand-subtle	#FDF0E8	#3A2415	Rare — selected states, focused slot

The brand colour is genuinely mode-specific. Dark mode lifts to a brighter orange and flips the text on it from white to near-black. The same hex value in both modes would either wash out or fail contrast. This is the clearest example of why every colour must be a token, never a literal.

Status colours

Four booking states and the business states share one muted set. These are the only colours besides the brand colour — deliberately desaturated so they inform without competing.

State	Light fill	Light text	Dark fill	Dark text
Pending	#FAF6ED	#8A6D3B	#35291A	#D9B87C
Approved	#EFF5F1	#4A6B58	#1E2E24	#8FC4A5
Rejected	#FBF0F0	#8B5555	#3A2422	#D69B96
Cancelled	#F4F3F0	#6B6660	#2A2826	#9A938B

Business states reuse the same values: pending review maps to Pending, approved to Approved, rejected to Rejected, and suspended to Cancelled.

2. Typography

Typeface

DM Sans throughout. Rounder and warmer than the usual interface defaults, which suits the warm neutral base. Loaded as a variable font; no secondary display face.

Monospace is used only where character alignment genuinely matters — embed code snippets on the business profile screen, and nothing else.

Scale

Five sizes. One scale for the entire application — the dashboard and the public booking page use the same values. Where the booking page needs more presence, it takes it from whitespace and layout, not larger type.

Token	Size	Weight	Line height	Used for
text-2xl	24px	500	1.2	Page titles — one per screen
text-xl	18px	500	1.3	Section headings, card titles
text-base	15px	400 / 500	1.5	Body copy, table cells, input values
text-sm	13px	400	1.5	Secondary copy, metadata, labels
text-xs	11px	400	1.4	Badges, captions, timestamps

Two weights only: 400 and 500. Nothing heavier. Emphasis comes from size, colour, and position rather than weight — a 700-weight heading against these soft neutrals reads as shouting. If something needs to stand out and 500 is not enough, the answer is hierarchy, not more weight.

Rules

One page title per screen	A single text-2xl. If a screen seems to need two, it is two screens.
Sentence case everywhere	Buttons, headings, labels, menu items. Never title case, never all caps — including badges.
No terminal punctuation on labels	Headings and button labels take no full stop. Helper text and descriptions do.
Numbers use tabular figures	Times, dates, and counts align in columns. DM Sans supports this; enable it on tables.

3. Spacing, radius, and layout

Spacing scale

A 4px base. Only these values — no arbitrary numbers between them.

Token	Value	Typical use
space-1	4px	Icon to label, tight inline gaps
space-2	8px	Between related controls, compact row padding
space-3	12px	Card internal gaps, button padding
space-4	16px	Between form fields, card padding
space-6	24px	Between sections within a card
space-8	32px	Between cards, major layout blocks
space-12	48px	Page-level top spacing, empty-state padding

Radius

Token	Value	Applies to
radius-sm	6px	Buttons, inputs, selects, small controls
radius-md	10px	Cards, modals, panels, dropdowns
radius-full	9999px	Status badges, avatars, pills only

Nothing else. A fourth radius value means two elements that should have matched no longer do.

Density

Density follows the *task*, not the screen. Scanning many items calls for compact; completing one thing calls for comfortable. A single screen may contain both.

	Compact	Comfortable
Used for	Bookings table, admin business list, availability grid, any scannable list	Forms, the public booking page, business profile, registration, form builder
Row / field spacing	8px vertical	16px vertical
Section gaps	16px	24px
Control height	32px	40px
Rationale	The owner is scanning many rows; more visible at once is the actual job	One task at a time; there is no reason to crowd it

Mobile

Touch targets 44px minimum on any interactive element. This overrides compact density — a 32px row is fine with a mouse and unreliable with a thumb.

Tables become cards	Data lists stack into cards on narrow viewports rather than remaining cramped tables with horizontal scroll.
Slot grid	The public booking page's time slots are the most-tapped element in the product. They get generous targets regardless of how many fit per row.
Scope reminder	Only the public booking page is optimised for mobile. Owner and admin screens must not break, but are not tuned for it.

4. Component states

Buttons

Variant	Resting	Hover	Purpose
Primary	brand fill, brand-on text	brand-hover fill	The single main action on a screen
Secondary	Transparent, border-strong outline	surface-1 fill	Everything alongside the primary action
Ghost	Transparent, no border	surface-1 fill	Low-emphasis actions, icon buttons, table row actions
Destructive	Transparent, rejected text and border	rejected subtle fill	Delete a form field, reject a booking

One primary per view If two actions both feel primary, one of them is not. Demote it to secondary.

Active state Scale to 98% on press. No colour change beyond the hover value.

Disabled text-disabled label on surface-1, no border. Prefer keeping buttons enabled and explaining on use.

Loading Label is replaced by a spinner at the same width, so the button does not resize mid-action.

Inputs

State	Treatment
Resting	surface-2 fill, border-strong outline, radius-sm
Hover	Outline darkens one step
Focus	2px brand ring, outline removed. The only place the brand colour appears outside a primary button.
Error	rejected outline, message below in text-sm, persistent until resolved
Disabled	surface-1 fill, text-disabled value, no outline

Status badges

Shape radius-full, text-xs, 4px vertical and 10px horizontal padding

Colour Fill and text from the status pair in section 1. Never an outline-only badge.

Case Sentence case. "Pending", not "PENDING".

Placement Right-aligned in list rows; beside the title in detail views.

Cards and panels

Card surface-2 fill, border hairline, radius-md, 16px padding

No shadows Elevation comes from surface value and hairlines. Shadows are reserved for genuinely floating elements — modals and dropdowns only.

Dense lists Bordered rows inside one card, not a stack of individually-bordered cards. A list of twenty cards reads as noise.

5. Patterns

Elements that appear across many screens. Specified once so they do not drift between them.

Icons

Lucide throughout, since it ships with the chosen component library. Introducing a second icon set means two visual languages for the same job.

Size	Used for
16px	Inline with text, inside buttons, table row actions
20px	Navigation items, section headers
24px	Empty and error states, and nothing else
Stroke	1.5 — lighter than the library default, which reads heavy against DM Sans and hairline borders
Colour	text - secondary by default, text - primary when the parent is active or hovered
Never brand	Icons do not take the brand colour. That stays reserved for primary actions.

Shadows

Token	Used for
shadow-sm	Dropdowns, popovers, select menus
shadow-md	Modals, dialogs, the embed popup
None	Everywhere else. Cards and panels take elevation from surface value and hairlines.

Shadows are a light-mode device. Against dark surfaces they are close to invisible, so in dark mode a raised element also steps up one surface level — surface -1 to surface -2. That step is the real elevation signal in dark.

Toasts

For action outcomes only — a booking approved, availability saved. Never for form validation, which needs a message that persists while the user corrects it.

Position	Bottom-right on desktop; bottom, full width, on mobile
Width	360px maximum
Duration	4 seconds for success, 6 for errors — an error needs longer to read
Stacking	Three visible at most, newest on top, older ones collapse
Contents	One line of text, plus an optional single action link such as "Undo" or "View". No title, no icon — an icon on a four-word message is noise.
Colour	Neutral surface with a coloured left border: approved for success, rejected for failure. Not a fully coloured background.

Empty and error states

Both sit centred in the content area, sharing one layout. An empty list is a normal, correct response — it must never read as a failure.

Icon	24px, text-muted for empty, rejected for error
Heading	text-base, naming the space — "No bookings yet", not "Nothing here"
Body	text-sm, text-secondary, one line explaining what fills it
Action	Optional for empty states where a genuine next step exists. Always present on errors, labelled "Try again".
Layout	48px vertical padding, centred, 320px maximum width so text does not stretch across a full table

Form layout

Labels	Above the field, always. Side labels break on mobile and force awkward column widths.
Label style	text-sm, text-primary, weight 500, 6px above the field
Helper text	text-xs, text-secondary, 6px below the field, present from the start
Error message	Replaces helper text in the same position, text-xs, rejected colour. Same position means the layout does not jump when an error appears.
Required fields	Mark the optional ones with "(optional)" rather than asterisking the required ones. Most fields are required; marking the exceptions is less noise.
Spacing	16px between fields, 24px between groups
Buttons	Right-aligned at the bottom, primary rightmost

Motion

Duration	Used for
150ms	Hover, focus, colour changes
200ms	Dropdowns, tooltips, toast entry
250ms	Modals, the embed popup, slide-in panels
Easing	ease-out entering, ease-in leaving
Ceiling	Nothing animates longer than 250ms
No entrance animation	No animation on page load, no staggered list reveals. A dashboard that animates every time you open it becomes tiring by the third visit.
Reduced motion	Honour prefers-reduced-motion by dropping all transitions to zero. One line of CSS, and it genuinely matters for some users.

6. Non-negotiable rules

These exist because breaking any one of them is what produces the drift this document is meant to prevent — three slightly different greys, four heading sizes that were never meant to differ.

1	Never write a raw colour value in a component	Every colour comes from a theme token. A single hardcoded hex breaks dark mode silently and cannot be found by searching for a token name. This is the rule that makes dark mode a configuration change rather than an audit of eighteen screens.
2	Never introduce a size outside the scale	Five type sizes, seven spacing values, three radii. If something needs an in-between value, the layout is wrong, not the scale.
3	One brand colour, one purpose	Orange marks the primary action and the focus ring. Not tabs, not links, not icons, not charts. The moment it appears elsewhere it stops meaning anything.
4	One primary button per view	If two actions both look primary, the user has to decide what the screen wants. Demote one.
5	Sentence case, always	Every label, heading, button, badge, and menu item. No title case, no all-caps.
6	Two font weights	400 and 500. Hierarchy comes from size, colour, and spacing.
7	Status colour is for status only	Green, amber, and red never appear as decoration. Seeing green anywhere in this product must mean approved.
8	Verify both modes before a screen is done	Not at the end of the build. A screen is not finished until it has been looked at in dark mode.

Theme configuration

These values become the theme configuration, which is the single source of truth referenced by every component. The dark values are applied under a mode selector rather than as a separate palette.

```
colors: {  
  surface: { 0, 1, 2 }  
  border: { DEFAULT, strong }  
  text: { primary, secondary, muted, disabled }  
  brand: { DEFAULT, hover, on, subtle }  
  status: { pending, approved, rejected, cancelled } × { bg, text }  
}  
fontSize: { xs: 11, sm: 13, base: 15, xl: 18, '2xl': 24 }  
spacing: { 1: 4, 2: 8, 3: 12, 4: 16, 6: 24, 8: 32, 12: 48 }  
borderRadius: { sm: 6, md: 10, full: 9999 }
```

Theme selection

The application follows the operating system preference by default. A manual toggle overriding that choice is added once the core screens are working — the system-preference behaviour is nearly free with the chosen tooling, while the toggle requires persistence and first-load handling.